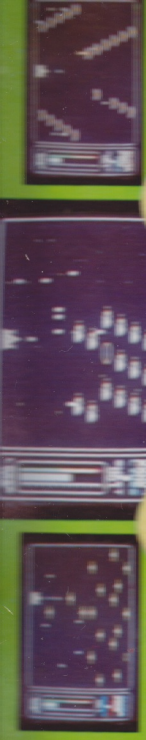

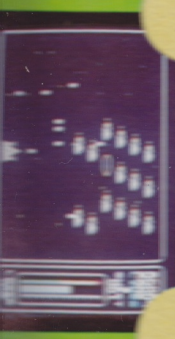

A battle spectacular in the classic mould – defend your mother planet from the alien hordes. Put to test your skills as gunnery commander as the space invaders launch wave after wave of laser bombs. Will your nerve last out and reflexes quicken as each success you attain is met by an even faster attack the following level.

XARGON WARS

Commodore 16

Commodore 16 — Gremlin Graphics

XARGON WARS

for Commodore 16

16 Screens **Multi Level**

Instructions for Play

To start game refer to selection screen. Select number of lives, sound on/off, demo mode and play by moving box to appropriate point and press fire.

To select joystick press J (either port)
keyboard press K

How to Load

Type L O A D Press [RETURN]

When Ready

Type R U N Press [RETURN]

Features

16 alien space attackers
Laser bombs
Laser Temperature Gauge
Overheat and in the red laser becomes inactive until cooled and green

How to Score

Screen No.1	Alien Points
1	1
2	2
3	3
4	4
5	5
6	6
7	7
8	8
9-16	10

How to Move

Left	ESC
Right	1
Fire	F1
Up	F3
Down	Help

High score table

To select letter* Left & Right
Alter letter Up & Down
Exit Fire
* Letter being edited is highlighted.

200 bonus points at level completion.
Extra life every **1,000** points and at level completion.

JOIN US NOW!

The Gremlin is on the look out for all those modern-thinking software superheroes who'd like to join together and get more than just games playing fun from their computer. The Gremlin Gang is a software club whose membership have the opportunity through the regular newsletter to get a direct insight into one of the premier software houses, to exchange ideas with other members and to benefit from the many exclusive offers. If you're looking to get ahead of your friends, join the Gremlin Gang today.

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*extra sweatshirts can be ordered by club members only at the reduced rate of £6.99 each.

Look out for other great Gremlin titles on Commodore 16

Gremlin Gang order form overleaf.

COMMODORE /16/ PLUS 4

COMMODORE SOFTWARE		TRADE	RETAIL
FCOM01	Introduction to Basic Part One	9.10	14.95
FCOM02	Zortek & The Microchips	7.50	12.99
FCOM03	Hide & Seek	6.10	9.99
FCOM04	Number Builder (Cart)	7.29	11.99
FCOM05	Number Chaser (Cart)	7.29	11.99
FCOM06	Jack Attack (Cart)	9.10	14.99
FCOM07	Vidiuzzles (Cart)	7.29	11.95
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FCOM12	Harbour Attack	3.64	5.99
FCOM13	Stella Wars/Blitz	3.64	5.99
FCOM14	Crazy Golf	3.64	5.99
FCOM15	Fireant	3.64	5.99

ANIROG		TRADE	RETAIL
FANI03	3D Time Trek	3.93	6.95
FANI04	Las Vegas	3.93	6.95
FANI05	Out on a Limb	3.93	6.95

A Tale to Tell....

We've made great storylines. We've created great features. And now we've set out to enjoy a bit of old fashioned entertainment ..... "Xargon Wars" for the new Commodore 16.

A classic stand 'em up and shoot 'em down arcade battle spectacular and the finest graphics and fast action package to come to the Commodore 16 market.

Gremlin Graphics has defined a market for software titles of the finest quality. Fast, easy rolling graphics as depicted by Potty Pigeon and Suicide Express. Interesting and absorbing arcade adventures hallmarked by the hit series of Monty Mole exploits. And now we've created something we've never tried before - the all action extravaganza of an arcade shoot out. And all the qualities you would expect have been crammed into one amazing value for money package,

-well defined and interesting graphics
-smooth, fast moving action
-16 different subject screens
-multi-level, difficulty edging on the impossible

Qualities that have yet to come to the new Commodore 16 market.

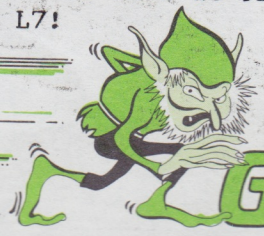
Rest your brain from all these clue solving dramas, let your head enjoy a good blast out and watch a new machine come alive! "Xargon Wars" is here to set a standard for the Commodore 16.

XARGON WARS COMMODORE 16 Retail Price £6.95

Contact Ian Stewart (0742) 753423 to place your order.

P.S. Don't miss Gremlin Graphics at the LET '85 show at Olympia - 16th, 17th and 18th February - Stand L7!

The fastest moving software around...



Gremlin Graphics

Gremlin Graphics, Alpha House, 10 Carver Street, Sheffield S1 4FS. Tel: (0742) 753423

We tantalised them on Spectrum

(Potty Pigeon, Monty Mole, Monty is Innocent)

We fascinated them on CBM 64

(Suicide Express, Potty Pigeon, Monty Mole)

And now we are going to zap them on COMMODORE 16 WITH XARGON WARS

Gremlin Graphics highly successful team of software genii have turned their attention to the new Commodore 16. This game starved system is a wide open market for exciting software and they don't come better than this battle spectacular in the classic mould.

Don't be a victim in the battle for sales be a victor by stocking XARGON WARS.

The fastest moving software around...

Gremlin Graphics

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L.7

FOR SNEAKY PREVIEWS OF GREMLIN'S FUTURE RELEASES WHICH INCLUDE *SAFEBREAKER, SUPERSLEUTH IN DAM TROUBLE* AND OUR FIRST TITLE FOR THE C16, *XARGON WARS*

CONTACT IAN STEWART OR KEVIN NORBURN

he fastest moving software around

Graphics, Alpha House, 10 Carver Street, Sheffield S1 4FS. Tel: (0742) 753423

Gremlins in new machine

You have a choice of creatures for your machine from Gremlin Graphics — a tycoon, hungry beetles or aliens.

Tycoon Tex, £6.95 for the C16, is set in the Old West where Tex patrols his oil pipeline to keep it safe from aerial bomb attacks, surface missiles and crash explosives. Petals of Doom, £6.95 for C16 and Plus/4, is set in a garden. Yes, one of those flowery things, but the flowers are in danger of invasion by alien bugs. Xargon Wars in another original for the C16 and Plus/4 machines and sells for £6.95. It's a standard arcade graphics-action with 16 subject screens and various levels of difficulty "edging on the impossible."

Contact: Gremlin Graphics, Alpha House, 10 Carver Street, Sheffield S1 4FS. Tel: 0742-753423.

IPUTER TRADE WEEKLY Monday February 25 1985 Page 13

Gremlin wars

Gremlin Graphics has released its first title for the C16, entitled *Xargon Wars*. Retailing at £6.95, *Xargon Wars* was written mainly by Tony Clarke, an ex-Statesoft and PSS programmer.

Described as an "all action extravaganza of an arcade shoot-out", *Xargon Wars* is being sold as the "finest graphics and fast action package to come to the C16 market". It has 16 different subject screens.

- If you want to make a complete fool of yourself, why not opt for CRL's first game for the C16 and Plus/4, Berks, selling at £6.95. Or immerse yourself in a fast and furious arcade shoot out – Xargon Wars, £6.95, from Gremlin Graphics.

Commodore Business Machines, 1 Hunters Road, Weldon, Corby, Northants, NN17 1QX; tel. 0536 205555.

CRL, CRL House, 9 Kings Yard, Carpenter's Road, London E15 2HD; tel. 01-533 2918.

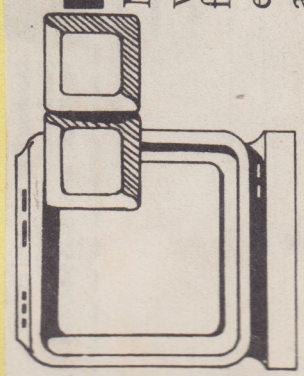
Gremlin Graphics, Alpha House, 10 Carver Street, Sheffield, S1 4FS; tel. 0742 753423.

MICRO PROJECTS LIMITED

MICRO PROJECTS is an established software development company working in conjunction with major software houses. Recent demand for our product has become so great that we are looking for experienced 6502 and Z80 assembly language programers, for original and conversion work.

Call MARK ROGERS on (0438) 318452 *or apply in writing to:*

Software Development Manager
Micro Projects Ltd
Business & Technology Centre
Bessemer Drive
Stevenage
Herts. SG1 2DX



April 8 1985 Page 7

Software Shorties . . .

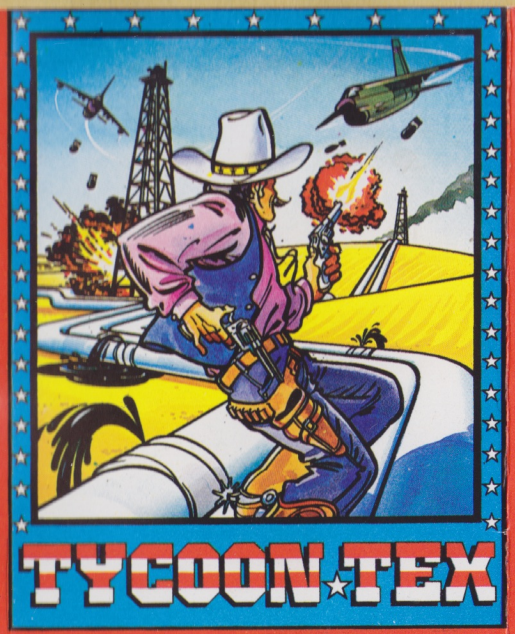
Software Shorties . . .
Software Shorties . . .

Tycoon Tex

Look out JR you ain't seen nothing yet!

Tycoon Tex is a 'rootin', 'tootin' oil tycoon in the true wild west tradition. Guns blazing, eyes gazing, the faster he can make his pipeline patrol the quicker he can add to his bank balance.

CBM16 Plus 4



Commodore 16 Plus 4 — Gremlin Graphics

Tycoon Tex

Commodore 16/Plus 4

6 lives **99 levels**

Instructions for Play

Game Plan
Follow the pipeline protecting it with your sixgun from danger, the faster you move, the quicker the pressure builds up. A break in the pipeline, which you must jump, and the pressure drops quickly, when zero, the game is ended. When a completed pipeline has been run move to the next level. Desert, ice and surface pipe scenes.

Features
Jet Plane & Bombs, Bouncy Bomb, Crash Explosives and 'Arrows'.

How to Score

Jet Plane Bombs	**250** points
Crash Explosive	**200** points
Bouncy Bomb	**50** points
'Arrow'	**25** points

Bonus at end of level is the oil pressure you had left when you finished the level.

How to Move
K or J to select keyboard or joystick
Z left/slow down X right/speed up
; up/jump ?/ down – (also used in entering name on high score tab)
Sound ON/OFF

Selection Screen Move up and down to bring your chosen option into highlighted selection window. Press FIRE to execute.

How to Load Load " " Press Enter

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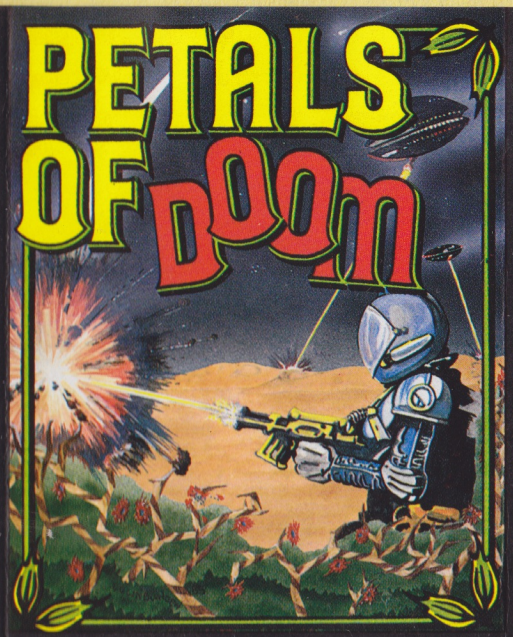
THE GREMLIN GANG

Look out for the other great Commodore 16 titles
XARGON WARS
PETALS OF DOOM

PETALS OF DOOM

Trapped within an eerie space cavern, the only way home is to help the flower plantation reach full growth. Only then will energy curtains blocking your way finally disappear. But, true to all classic space shoot-outs, the plant-hating

CBM16 /Plus 4



Commodore 16 Plus 4 — Gremlin Graphics

PETALS OF DOOM

Commodore 16/Plus 4

6 lives **99 levels**

Instructions for Play

Game Plan
You can walk and fly. Blast the aliens with your laser before they stamp the flowers which you can hide behind if they are tall enough. When all the flowers are fully grown, the energy curtain disappears and you can then move to the next level. Keep an eye on your power pack gauge which decreases as you fire or fly. An alarm sounds when the power pack is inactive – collision with aliens also drains your power.

How to Score
Shoot alien bugs. Points vary from 10-60.
An extra man is given every 10,000 points.

How to Move
Z Left X Right Shift Up Space Down
Return Fire ESCAPE Return to Menu
To select Joystick press J Keyboard press K
P Pause On G Pause Off

Selection Screen Move Spaceman to Select Option
Press FIRE To enter your name on the High Score table, use either joystick or direction keys and press Fire to execute.

How to Load Type Load Press Return.

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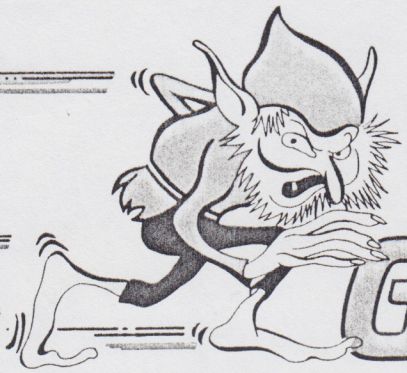
Xargon Wars
Tycoon Tex



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GREMLIN GRAPHICS - THE STORY SO FAR

Thank you for visiting the Gremlin Graphics stand. After only seven months of trading we have established ourselves as one of the UK's leading software houses.

This has been achieved by producing high quality, original product backed up by effective advertising and promotions. It is our intention during 1985 to consolidate our position in the market by expanding on our range and introducing software for the Commodore 16 and the Amstrad.

Our main efforts will be concentrated on the Spectrum market, as our team of programmers now includes Christian Urqhuart of Hunchback and Decathalon fame, and who is currently writing 'Beaver Bob in Dam Trouble'; Chris Kerry who is well known for his Jack and the Beanstalk program and who has just finished 'Monty is Innocent'; Peter Harrap who was seen on every national news broadcast on 27th July 1984 with the brilliant 'Wanted: Monty Mole' classic. Peter has just finished 'Sam Stoat - Safebreaker' and is heavily involved in designing 'Monty on the Run' which will be a platform/arcade game with some very interesting features. Finally for the Spectrum is Shaun Hollingworth, our only Spectrum programmer not to have had a number one hit - we have a feeling this will change fairly shortly with the release of 'Supersleuth' and the zany adventures of Grumpy Gumphrey.

Our Commodore 16 product is being written by the team of programmers who wrote Frak for the CBM 64 and we believe that the quality of these programs is the best available; they will aslo be writing CBM 64 programs for Gremlin including a version of 'Monty on the Run'.

Our in-house Commodore 64 writer is John Flynn whose first program for Gremlin Graphics will be called 'Thing on a Spring', an amusing game featuring a very lovable bouncing character who is terrorised by the evil Goblin.

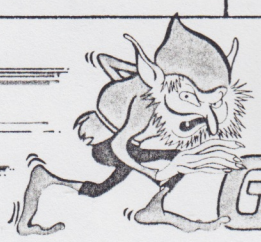
We look forward to supporting you during 1985 and wish you a very prosperous year. If you should require any further information, please do feel free to approach Kevin Norburn or Ian Stewart who are in attendance at this show.

For amazing graphics and outstanding sound effects run a Gremlin through your micro.

A Tale to Tell....
Product Release Information

PROGRAM TITLE	MACHINE	RELEASE DATE
XARGON WARS	C16	13.02.85
SAFEBREAKER	SPECTRUM 48K	14.02.85
PETALS OF DOOM	C16	26.02.85
IN DAM TROUBLE	SPECTRUM 48K	12.03.85
TYCOON TEX	C16	19.03.85
SUPERSLEUTH	SPECTRUM 48K	02.04.85
THING ON A SPRING	CBM 64	02.04.85

The fastest moving software around...



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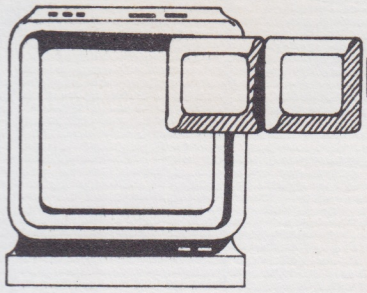

MICRO PROJECTS LIMITED

The Green House, 151 Beach Road, St. Albans. Hertfordshire AL3 5AN

Telephone: (0727) 34566/(0438) 814618

Directors: M.Rogers, A.Clarke, J.Perkins (Company Secretary)

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Sixteen Up

At last, a number of the leading software houses have noticed the C16. Phil Bonner assesses what they have to offer.

IF YOU BOUGHT A COMMODORE 16 last Christmas you were one of many, and you may now be feeling rather disappointed at the small quantity of good software that has so far appeared. If so, cheer up! Large numbers of games are beginning to hit the market and, although many of them are rewritten from other machines, they are none the worse for that. I have taken a good look at a number of the first offerings from the independent software houses and, although some are poor, several others are well worth buying. For convenience, I have grouped them in categories.

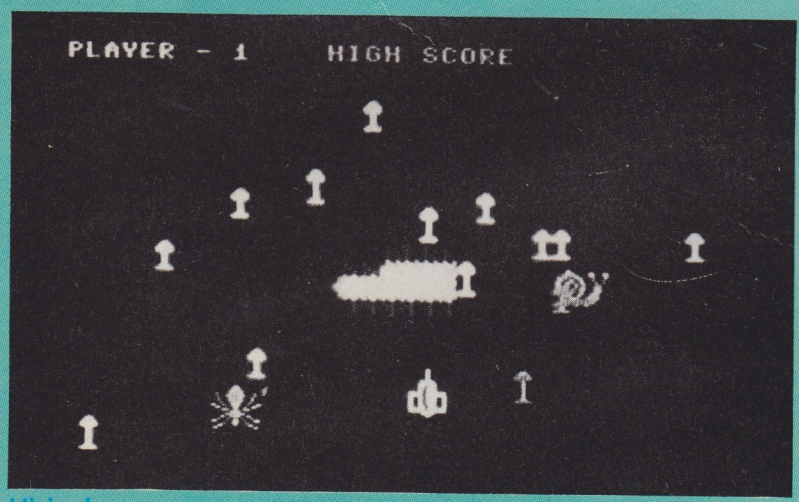
Shoot-em-up games

Everybody wants to own at least one game based on Space Invaders, and **Xargon Wars**, from Gremlin Graphics, is an excellent example of its type. Nothing about the game is original, yet it is colourful, challenging and addictive.

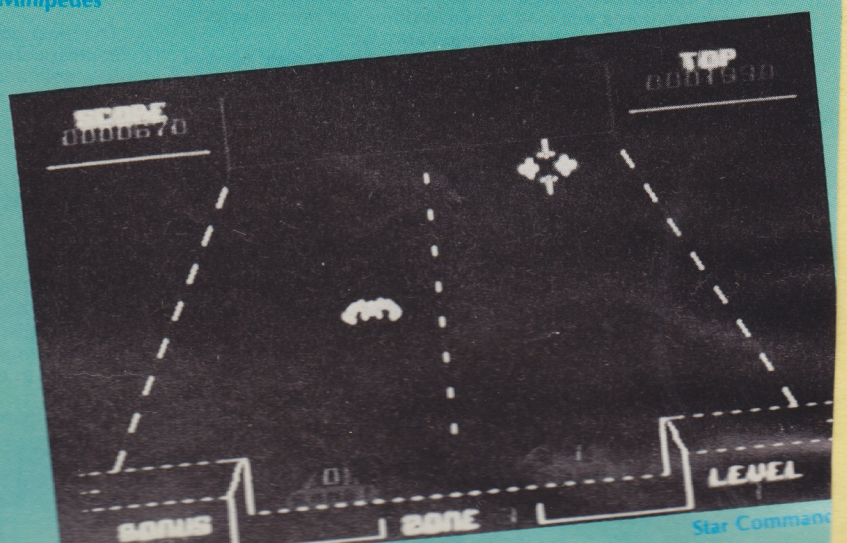
You shoot from the ground at wave after wave of aliens — sixteen types in all — which are intent on bombing you out of existence. The aliens move in a variety of flight patterns, so a different strategy is needed for each screen, and they take forms which range from meteorites to giant birds. The chief difficulty lies in avoiding their bombs, which rain down fast and furious — lightning reactions are necessary! Xargon Wars is written in machine code and shows just what can be achieved within 16K of memory. It sets a very high standard for other authors to emulate.

Tynesoft's **Zap-Em** is in some ways similar, but now you are also able to move vertically, up to about a third of the way up the screen. For some peculiar reason the aliens are attacking in helicopters, though later waves change to cubes and flying saucers. Some of them drop bombs, which look like letter Z's though the main problem lies in avoiding the aliens themselves, as they meander gently from right to left, gradually getting lower as they proceed. Rather sneakily, some of them have been made invulnerable, so you have to dodge them and not rely solely on your firepower. The game is well conceived, but suffers slightly from a lack of variety. It is also infuriating that you can only fire one shot at a time, but nevertheless it is fast and quite addictive.

Xargon Wars



Minipedes



Star Command

C.16
1 (5) Wizard & the Princess(Mel. House)
2 (4) Vegas Jackpot (Melbourne House)
3 (1) Roller Kong (Melbourne House)
4 (—) Xargon Wars (Gremlin)
5 (7) Games Tape 1 (Melbourne House)
6 (2) Games Tape 2 (Melbourne House)
7 (8) Berks (CRS)
8 (9) Flight 015 (Craig Communications)
9 (10) Williamsburg Adv. (Microdeal)
10 (4) Stellar War/Blitz (CBM)
(Compiled by Websters Software)

POPULAR COMPUTING WEEKLY

25 APRIL-1 MAY 1985

planned for the Commodore 64, some conversions and some originals, as well as games for the C16 and Amstrad. All of which must be keeping Gremlin Graphics very busy, and it seems that Ian is thumbing his nose at the traditional summer slump.

'Obviously the sales figures that you achieve over Christmas are double those you achieve for the other times of the year, but I think keeping the market buoyant for the rest of the year is very important. I don't mind getting lower sales through the summer — it keeps the Gremlin name prominent; and it keeps the programmers busy — it's important for them to be able to work twelve months of the year rather than six and it's important for us to have revenue coming in for twelve months of the year rather than six! I would hate to think I was holding product back just for Christmas.'

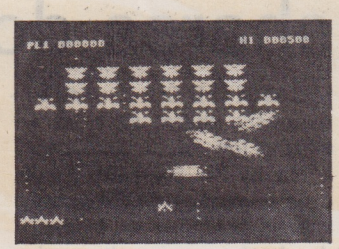
Looking at 'the prison' there is obviously plenty of room to expand, should they wish to. At present Gremlin employs four full-time in-house Z80 programmers all writing for the Spectrum, Pete Harrap, Chris Kerry, Shaun Hollingworth and Christian Urquhart. A company called Micro Projects consisting of three programmers write Gremlin's Commodore games and conversions, and Ian is investigating other talent. 'I would like to see our in-house personnel double this year, to a maximum of ten, so that we have at least one programmer who is competent on one of the major machines, by which I mean Spectrum, Commodore, Amstrad and Atari. That means we are on the look out for more programmers and more product.'

SOFT ★ HITS

Galactic

There aren't many variations possible on the age-old theme of Galaxions, but when it's done well it can still be a very exciting game. Solar's version for the C16 is a conversion of a program for earlier machines, but stands up fairly well.

Compared to the similar Xargon Wars from Gremlin, Galaxions is perhaps inferior graphically but superior sonically. As usual, the baddies stream in from the sides of the



screen, whirling and diving, then form a pattern at the top. Your gunship moves left and right at the bottom, and all you have to do is zap the baddies as they dive down at you. The animation is a bit flickery, but to make up for it the sound effects are very good — it just goes to show what can be done with a little imagination, even when you're limited by the C16's sound chip.

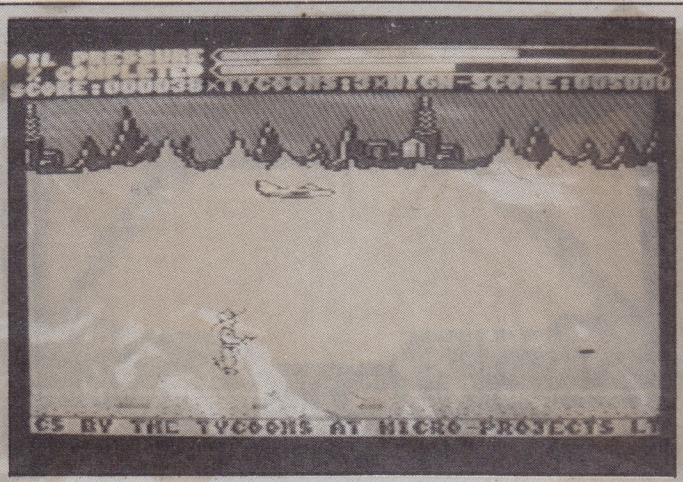
You have the traditional three lives, and there are lots of screens to get through. What more could you want? Well, it would be nice to have something which isn't a conversion, and ideally a totally original idea. Still, I expect most C16 owners are first-time computer users, and may well be happy to play versions of the classics for the moment. I'm looking forward, though, to seeing more originals and fewer oldies on the C16.

Program: Galaxions, C16
Supplier: Solar
Price: £6.95
Graphics: ★★★★★
Sonics: ★★★★★★
Gameplay: ★★★★★

Rootin' tootin'

Tycoon Tex is one of the better C16 efforts so far. Released by Gremlin at the same time as two other C16 programs, Xargon Wars and Petals of Doom, it's also a reasonably original idea, which makes a nice change.

Tex is a gun-toting oil tycoon whose mission is the patrol his pipeline defending it from all sorts of horrors — breaks in the line, bouncy springs, fighter attacks, arrows and bombs.



You control Tex's speed as he dashes along the pipeline, and make him jump to avoid the breaks. There's a time limit for the completion of each of the three screens — desert, ice and surface — but as you go faster the pressure in the pipeline builds up, so it's more likely to burst. If the oil pressure drops to zero, or if you run out of time, you've lost.

You have six lives and ninety-nine levels to complete, with options including keyboard/joystick, sound on/off, and so on. The background graphics are nice though the foreground characters aren't remarkable, and the sound's OK.

All in all, it's a decent pot-boiler, and I suppose we should be grateful that the basic idea is fairly original.

Program: Tycoon Tex, C16
Supplier: Gremlin Graphics
Price: £6.95
Graphics: ★★★★★
Sonics: ★★★★★
Gameplay: ★★★★★

ORKBLAST

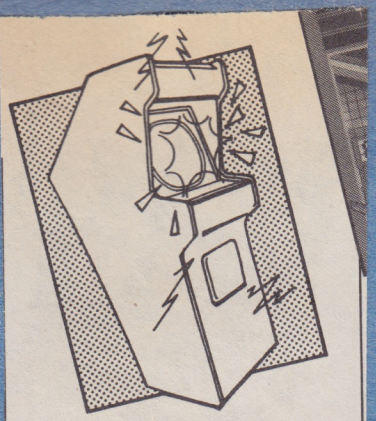
Dilemma is a new ma-
ode arcade game for
. That in itself is worth
ing. In fact the game
d, it seems to me, to a
m game called *Eric*
Floaters.
e are 25 screens, all
ns on the same thing –
ature of walls and

3 JULY 1985

are simply relocated
different colour. The
dea of the game is that
ittle sprite darts about
reen planting bombs
will blow up other, nas-
prites. The bomb blast
ot extend through the
consequently the idea
game is to get baddies
er and drop a bomb
ensuring in the few
ds you have before it
des you have got safely
d a wall.
really fairly entertain-
The bomb blast/wall
whilst not I think origi-
asn't been done to death
oes allow for the intro-
on of strategic thought.
hically this is nothing
al, though, and on other
ines it would make a
ish £1.99 game. On the
it is one of the better
es.

ram *Dork's Dilemma*
e *£6.95*
o *C16*
lier *Gremlin Graphics*

Alpha House
10 Carver Street
Sheffield S1 4FS



Tycoon Tex

This game appears to be original, but after a short period it became clear that it was a variation on the agility/endurance type, with only a change of theme.

The concept is simple. You must guide Tex down a pipe line avoiding breaks in the pipe and nasties like aircraft which bombs. The pipe lies along the bottom of the screen and motion is implied by scrolling from right to left. Your horizontal position can be varied enabling you to shoot and avoid nasties. The first screen depicts a pipeline crossing the desert and the second is the frozen north.

Apart from the pipe, the only other graphical area is a collection of hills/buildings on the skyline. A feeling of depth is achieved by scrolling different parts of the screen at different rates. This scrolling is well executed and quite smooth. The various figures and objects appear to be built up from several redefined characters and are well animated. The graphics are well designed and colourful with extensive use of shading.

The instructions are very weak. Consequently whilst there appeared to be a sound option, I couldn't get it turned on! Overall the game shows the capabilities of the C16 well.

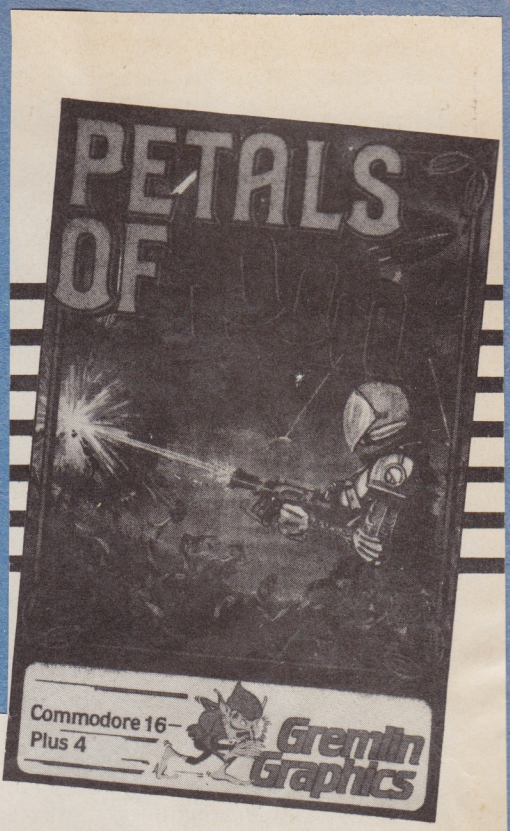
The main drawback of the game is the lack of variety. I found myself getting bored before I had got half way through the first screen. Whilst this isn't a bad game, even at the price I don't feel it's very good value. **M.W.**

Price: £6.50

Publisher: Gremlin Graphics

Address: Alpha House, 10 Carver St, Sheffield

C16



Petals of Doom
★ ★ ★
Gremlin Graphics
£6.95
C16 or Plus/4

GARDEN PESTS ARE A menace, and the varieties found in outer space are the worst kind! Your task is to hunt down and destroy all sorts of alien bugs in 99 plantations of space-flowers. By enabling the five plants in each garden to reach maturity, you may proceed to the next level. There are many kinds of alien insects, each of which moves in a different pattern, and some pose a worse threat than others. On the higher levels the procedure is repeated, but with more bugs to kill. The pests are destroyed by you firing at them, while flying above ground with the aid of a power supply in your back pack. Once your batteries run low you are helpless until they are recharged. You may choose to have up to six lives.

As with other games from Gremlin, the graphics are superb and the use of sound is also good. The game suffers, however, from lack of variety and, although it is fun to play, I suspect that I would tire of it quite quickly. Otherwise it might have merited a fourth star.

PRB

Title: Dorks Dilemma
Computer: C16
Supplier: Gremlin Graphics
Price: £6.95

When the first batch of C16 software arrived it was mostly conversions of C64 games and because of this limitation it was uniformly bad. This 'second' wave however is producing some very good games that have not been seen on other machines — Dorks Dilemma is one such game.

The objective is to collect pieces of jigsaw puzzle which are contained within force fields about the

game becomes one of trying to wipe out as many guards as possible with one bomb. Once a piece has been obtained Dork can leave the screen via exits that are found on the edge of the screen he then ends up on a new screen with more guards and another piece to get!

During the game Dork can edit the jigsaw by pressing escape and using the joystick to move pieces around. If a piece shows white then it is in the correct place, if black it's not.

The graphics are average for the C16 as is the sound,

Tycoon Tex
★ ★ ★ ★
Gremlin Graphics
£6.95
C16 or Plus/4

TYCOON TEX, WE ARE TOLD, IS A rootin tootin oil tycoon who, surprisingly, spends his time not with Sue-Ellen but running along his pipeline and jumping over breaks in it! Somehow or other this adds a few more millions to his bank balance. He is under frequent attack, but he can shoot back, and gains valuable bonuses from destroying bombs, helicopters and other hazards. At the end of each section of pipe, points are awarded depending on the speed at which it was completed. Another section then begins, with a different setting and new enemies.

This game owes a good deal to Moon Buggy but it is quite brilliantly programmed, with first-rate scrolling graphics. There are 99 levels in all, with hazards which vary in difficulty from level to level. The title screen gives a high-score table and various options including a demo mode – the whole effect is very professional and impressive.

This is the first game of its type for the C16/Plus 4, and I recommend it highly. By its nature there is not a great deal of variety, but it is a real test of concentration and speed of reaction. So get out your six-gun and follow that pipeline!

PRB

Star chart

Dork's Dilemma

C-16
Gremlin Graphics
Maze game
£6.95
★ ★ ★
Slightly unusual in that the aliens try to trap you rather than kill you, though if you bump into them at any speed you've had your chips.

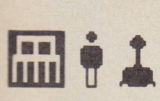
The graphics are all you would expect of the C-16 and the game is tactically interesting as you plant a time bomb and must be able to escape. Once you've killed all the aliens a piece of your craft is transferred out of the force field in the screen centre.

TOP 3 BY MACHINE

1	R.I.P.	M. Tronic
2	Rockman	M. Tronic
3	Mickey the Brickey	Firebird
1	Way of Exploding First	Melbourne House
2	Drop Zone	Centresoft
3	A View to Kill	Domark
1	A View to Kill	Domark
2	Dun Darach	Gargoyle
3	Action Biker	M. Tronic
1	Overdrive	Superior
2	Classic Adventure	Melbourne House
3	Football Manager	Addictive
1	Alien 8	Ultimate
2	Ghostbusters	Activision
3	Fighter Pilot	Digital Ing.
1	Ghostbusters	Activision
2	Flight Path	Anirog
3	Chuckie Egg	A & F
1	Atik Atak	Ultimate
2	Revs	Acorn
3	Lode Runner	S. Projects
1	Quasimodo	C. Soft
2	Ghostbusters	Activision
3	Fort Apocalypse	US Gold
1	Dorks Dilemma	Gremlin
2	Dark Tower	Melbourne House
3	BMX Racers	M. Tronics

Vc = Vic 20 64 = CBM 64
Sp = Spectrum Bc = BBC At
16 = CBM 16 El = Electron
Am = Amstrad Ms = MSX.
Source = Websters Software.

Title: Thing on a Spring
Computer: Commodore 64
Supplier: Gremlin Graphics
Price: £8.95



Thing on a Spring is in some ways similar to a ladders and platforms game in as much as there is only one correct way around the game. However the stunning originality of the game and the marvellous graphics more than make up for the old style of gameplay.

Your little springy thing must bounce around connected multiple screens. The main problem is to keep up your oil supply. If this runs down you will die. Oil is used upon collision with any of the surrounding attacking objects, they don't really attack, they just wander around in set, and sometimes not so set, patterns. These objects are also objects that will help you finish certain screens, like a device to make the escalators work, another thing that bounces you around the screen, etc. You will also find pieces of the object needed for the final showdown with the bad guy. I never got anywhere near that far, the first four screens were enough for me!

The graphical effects are superb, as I have already mentioned, with Gremlin Graphics' usual style of presentation throughout. The sound is also of a high quality with some good original music playing throughout the game.

The problem with this game is that it just defies description. So all I can say is that I think that it is very good, but have a look at it if you are going to buy it. But that can't be a bad thing.

Top Five C16 Games

1	(1)	Gremlins	Adventure International £9.95
2	(—)	Dork's Dilemma	Gremlin £6.95
3	(2)	BMX Racers	Mastertronic £1.99
4	(—)	Dark Tower	Melbourne House £5.95
5	(3)	Blagger	Alligata £6.95

Bubblers

ork's Dilemma

16 is such a relative mer to the home ter market that the re for it has consisted of games revamped. Hope- Dork's Dilemma heralds wn of a new age.

game consists of two , the first being a shoot ens game, the second a . In the first phase you a creature — either a man rrel or a tortoise, I'm not which — around a maze off a specified number of there are 25 rooms to re, each one different and one of a variety of aliens iting it. When you have sed of the nasties you are a part of the jigsaw which the second part of the

e screen is divided into two sections, the playing area n information area. In the mation area is a diagram ing your position — down e finest degree — and a containing your jigsaw s. These pieces are move- using the joystick — and you have completed this of the game you are ked to the beginning of a game but with more aliens estroy.

here is no music included the sound effects used, cially the bombs exploding ou run for cover, are well e. Overall, this is a delight- game, it's basis may not be pletely original but it's lementation is well thought . This is definitely something C16 and Plus 4 owners to k at.

M.W.

ce: £6.95

blisher: Gremlin Graphics

dress: Unit 10, The Parkway d Ctre, Heneage St, mingham B7

C16

Thing on a Spring

This is one of those games that are so addictive you cannot resist playing. On loading a nicely animated title page is displayed with a rather catchy tune playing in the background. You may start the game from here and use either the keyboard or the joysticks to play — the keys being totally user definable. There is also an option that will let you turn off/on the music and keep the special effects that are used in the game.

Your objective is to move Thing On A String through the factories and collect the nine pieces of a jigsaw. In the factories there are sinking floors, lifts, slides, etc. Wandering around are various strange objects that will drain your oil at a rapid rate. If your oil level gets too low then your spring will seize up and the game will inevitably end.

Between the screens there is a network of tunnels through which you must pass, in these you will find more oil draining creatures and obstacles in your way. At this stage you may also look at the jigsaw that you have so far completed.

The graphics are of an excellent quality; smooth scrolling, bright colours and imaginative designs have been used. To add variety to the game each screen contains different colours, designs and shapes each time you play.

Unfortunately the instructions are rather brief and lacking in detail. Apart from this it is an excellent game that I would strongly recommend.

K.I.

Price: £7.95

Publisher: Gremlin Graphics Software

Address: Alpha House, 10 Carver St, Sheffield S1 4FS

C64

JOIN NOW AND BECOME A SOFTWARE SUPER HERO
THE GREMLIN GANG

Look out for the other great Commodore 16 titles
XARGON WARS
PETALS OF DOOM
TYCOON TEX

JOIN US NOW!

The Gremlin is on the look out for all those modern-thinking software superheroes who'd like to join together and get more than just games playing fun from their computer. The Gremlin Gang is a software club whose membership have the opportunity through the regular newsletter to get a direct insight into one of the premier software houses, to exchange ideas with other members and to benefit from the many exclusive offers. If you're looking to get ahead of your friends, join the Gremlin Gang today.

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Order form overleaf.

Dork's Dilemma

Commodore 16/Plus 4

4 lives **25 screens**

Instructions for Play

Gameplay
On entering a screen a certain number of aliens must be eliminated with your time bomb (this will vary each time – see the right hand side of the screen for the exact number). Once you've killed all the aliens required, a piece of your craft is transferred from the force field in the centre of the screen, to the jigsaw on the right. Move onto the next screen via any of the flashing exits on the edge; if a screen has already been completed a message to this effect will appear to tell you, and you should then try a different exit.
Remember – when dropping a bomb you must move away quickly – linger at our peril!

How to Score **25 points each**
Zobwats **1000 points**
Bonus life

How to Move
F1 to select keyboard or joystick
F2 sound on/off Z left X right
;- up ?/ down
Space Bar – fire/drop bomb

Editing the Jigsaw – Press 'Escape' to enter the edit mode. Use the joystick or keys to move the cursor around the grid; use the spacebar to pick up and place the pieces. If a piece is in the correct position it will show white, otherwise it will be black. The piece being moved is shown to the left of the jigsaw grid.
To return to the game, press Escape again

To Load Type Load and press Return

Commodore 16 Plus 4

Gremlin Graphics

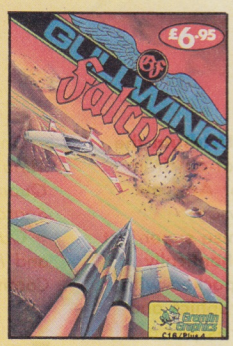
Dork's Dilemma

CBM16 Plus 4

Dork's Dilemma

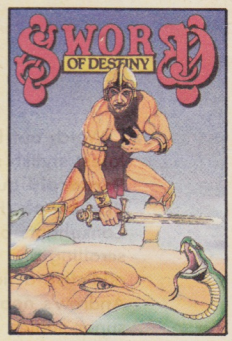
Plasma rocket failure. A space shattering collision with a planetoid form not known to any civilised solar system and a dazed, confused Dork awakens to find his disabled spaceship stripped and hidden

YOUR MICRO NEEDS GREMLIN!!



GULLWING FALCON C16

The ultimate defender. The lone saviour of your planet's destiny. Can you master the Gullwing Falcon and put to flight the invading space pirates. Pilot your awesome craft through waves of attackers, making full use of the Desert of Pillars, blasting your way to glorious victory.



SWORD OF DESTINY C16

Armed only with the magical sword, the lost soul of Kelok must overcome the horrors of the eerie Abyss of Death and reclaim the heart of this brave warrior stolen from the battlefield by Xorphas the evil warlock.

C16 CLASSICS C16

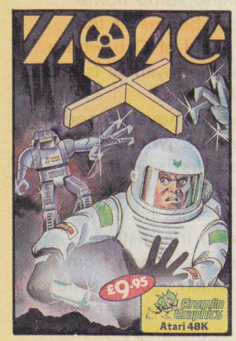
The years finest compilation of C16 spectaculars. An outstanding collection of games that have made their mark on their own but as a collection provide unbeatable value for money.

KUNG FU KID C16

Action packed martial arts spectacular the like of which has yet to be seen on the Commodore 16.

JETBRIX C16

Mind your head it's raining bricks! Watch your airspace the walls are taking over. You've got to be fast on the move, quick to the fire button to dodge this aerial assault and blast them to bits before they eventually overtake you. Real hovva bovva!



ZONE X Atari

The age of technology makes its demands, nuclear energy opens new horizons, but more and more plutonium waste is ever generated, however can it be made safe? Government storage tanks are full so they've resorted to disused mineshifts. But mankind breeds its own subversives, bent on destruction, who attempt to seize plutonium from one such shaft. The theft went badly wrong leaving this awesome material scattered around emitting its deadly radiation. Someone must put their life at risk before this tragic disaster becomes an awful reality.

KING OF THE RING Atari

Not merely a boxing game, a complete campaign of action to take your man to the very top – world championship. Guide your fighter from fresh faced novice through his programme of training and fight preparation for every contest. Instruct him in tactics with "between rounds" comments. Be his mentor in carefully selecting the next opponent – match your man carefully. Finally the big chance – the world championship.

XARGON'S REVENGE C16

Defeated and broken the warriors of Xargon have regrouped and reformed. Informers have alerted them of your horrific plan for their total destruction and now strengthened by the knowledge and experience of terrifying defeat they lie in wait to take their revenge on your invading armies.

Atari
£9.95
C16 CLASSICS

C16/Plus 4
£6.95

Gremlin Graphics Software Limited Alpha House, 10 Carver Street, Sheffield S1 4FS. Tel: (0742) 753423

C16 COLLECTION

The C16 Collection — 10 games no C16 owner should be without.

by Rory and Alex Newman

Hello! This month is a C16 owner's dream — a top ten of C16 greats. The C16 has been out a while now and lots of software has been released. Originally, there were the conversions, but due to the ingenuity of Gremlin Graphics and the budget price of Mastertronic, the C16 has become a games machine in its own right, as well as a programmer's paradise. The C16 is a very good machine; it has a beginner's basic better than the BBC, a built-in machine code monitor, good sound and a 320 × 200 hi-res graphic screen. It also has a 160 × 200 multi-colour hi-res screen. There are 128 colours and good sound, so it's little wonder there are so many great games for it.

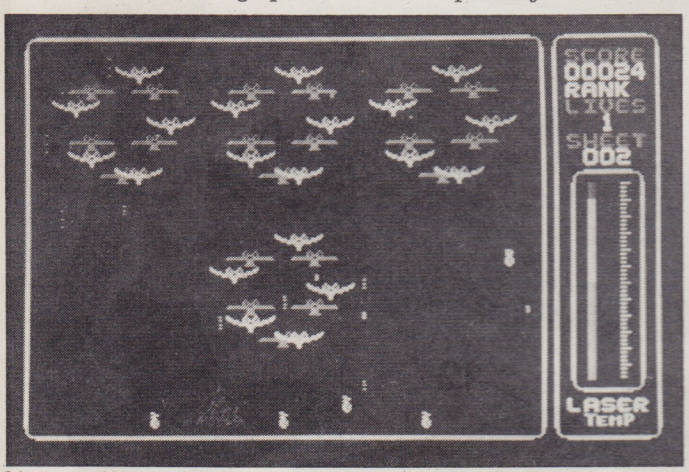
There are, however, two set-backs; firstly, it only has 16K memory, reduced to a minute 4K after the use of hi-res graphics and, secondly, the C64 is an established computer, so some of the major software companies, such as US Gold have, as yet, taken no real interest in it, although it is said that they will bring out some titles for it. Let us hope that it is true and they bring out such classics as Blue Max and Spy Hunter.

Commodore actually surprised me; some of their games are good — for instance, Space Sweep, Harbour Attack and Treasure Island. These games are great but due to fancy packaging, are over-priced and £7.95 each. If you buy them cheaply, or secondhand, they are very worthwhile, but, unless you have a special liking for one of their games, there are many better buys at that price.

24

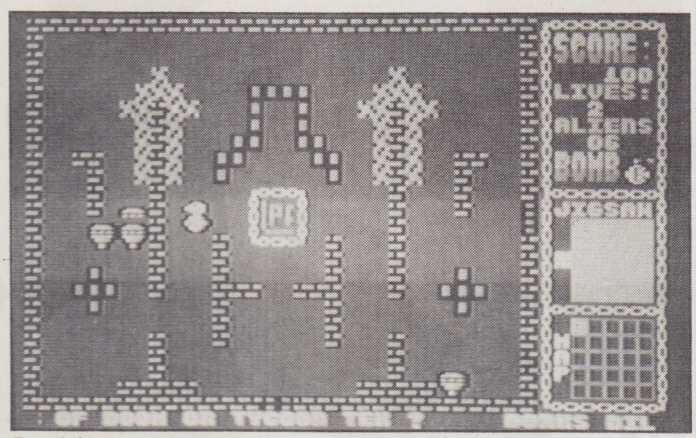
Number 1 — Classics I — Gremlin Graphics £9.95
This is a compilation tape which has four games on it.

Game 1 — Xargon Wars
A battle spectacular in the classic mould. Defend your mother planet against alien hordes. Put to the test your skills as gunnery commander as the space invaders launch wave after wave of laser bombs. Will your nerve last out and reflexes quicken as each success you attain is met by an even faster attack at the following level? You have probably now deduced that it is a "shoot-em-up" game but it is perfect: keyboard or joystick option, a six place high score table, demo mode, 16 screens, choice of number of lives. It is extremely responsive and also has a sound on/off option. One feature is laser temperature. This is in the box at the side that contains score lives, rank etc. and has three sections; green, yellow and red. Every time you fire, it goes up and slowly cools back down. If it reaches the red section, then your laser becomes inactive until it has cooled down to the green section. This changes the games from an auto fire/fire button firmly held down type of game to a strategic one. As the stages go by, you will see how to make sure you're not caught out by the laser temperature. The game is suberbly laid out and is a No. 1 in its very own right.



Xargon Wars

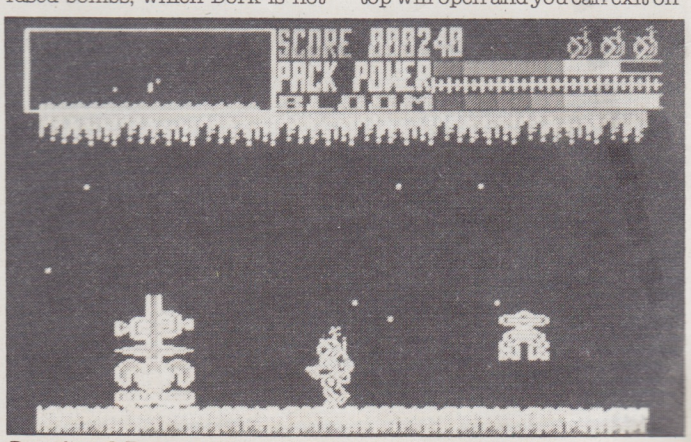
Game II — Tycoon Tex
The inlay to this makes interesting reading. "—Tycoon Tex is a rootin', tootin, oil tycoon in true wild west tradition. Guns blazin', eyes glazin', the faster he can make his pipe petrol, the quicker he can add to his bank balance. Sand, ice or snow can't hold Tex's speedy draw as he fights off the dangers of falling bombs, arrows, surface missiles and crash explosives. And, if he's a second too slow — **!!?? Boom — one more leak, one less barrel to add to his sticky hoard". What rubbish!! Gremlin Graphics have two very good but totally different ideas and have tried to make them mix. It doesn't work. You're walking along in Texas in the 19th century, jumping the gaps in your pipeline when a jet tries to bomb you! Then if you complete that stage, you move to Iceland. There's a 21st century background on all stages. It's an enjoyable but very screwy game.



Dork's Dilemma

Game III — Dork's Dilemma
This is a totally unique game and as far as I know there are no other version available for any other computer. Dork must collect the pieces of a jigsaw puzzle which are contained in a force field all over the planet. The force field will collapse when all the guards have been killed. To kill them you must drop short-fused bombs, which Dork is not immune to, so he has to run away. The game this seems to be to get as many of the guards together as possible, then dropping the bomb thus taking out as many as you can with one bomb. After a piece has been obtained, you go after the next piece, leaving via the side door. By pressing ESC you can go on to the jigsaw screen at any time. You can move the pieces about and, if they are in the right place, they will turn white, if not, black. Graphics and sound are quite good and it is a very interesting and enjoyable game.

Game IV — Petals of Doom
Petals of Doom is a "shoot-em-up" with a difference. The Petals refer to flowers as you might expect. The flowers get bombed by the nasties which you must destroy. You must save the flowers by flying around in your jetpac, shooting the nasties. When your jetpac runs out of energy, you can hide under the flowers for protection. Your energy decreases when you fly or fire. If the plants grow to their full height, the force field at the top will open and you can exit on



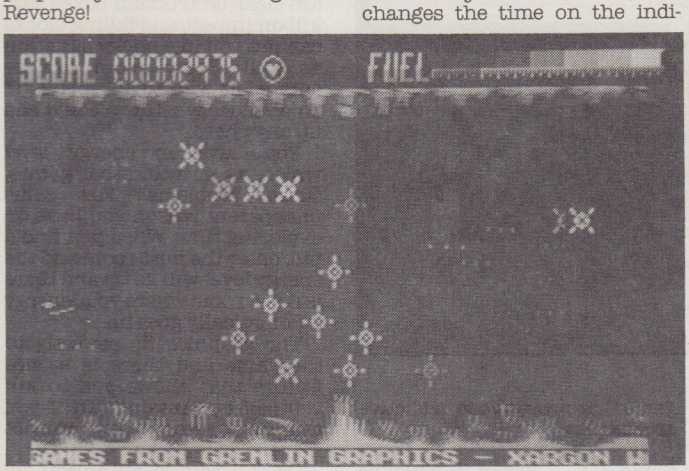
Petals of Doom

C16 COLLECTION

to another and more difficult screen. With the usual keyboard/joystick option. It has good graphics and sound. The game is, like the others on this tape, enjoyable and unique. This game really boosts the tape and makes it more worthwhile. The game proves that playing with flowers can be lethal!

Number 2 — Classics II — Gremlin Graphics £9.95
Another compilation tape of four games.

Game I — Xargon Revenge
The sequel to Xargon Wars and in comparison slightly disappointing. "The people of Xargon have never forgotten Xargon Wars and their humiliating defeat. They know your plan is to destroy them completely along with their four satellite planets. The bait has been set — so prepare yourself for Xargon's Revenge!

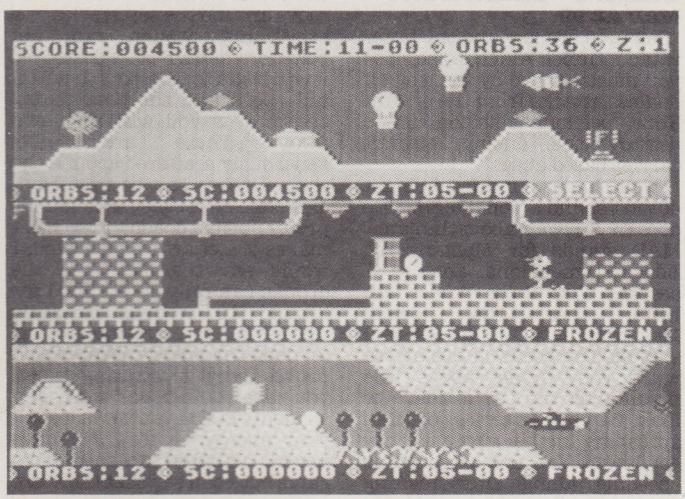


Xargons Revenge

The game lacks the enjoyment of Xargon Wars as it is just a poor defender. It is not as well laid out as Xargon Wars and is just a defender in which you only have UP, DOWN and FIRE. It has many screens which are just different graphics coming towards you. The inability to move left and right is most infuriating and is the main cause of loss of life. Rather disappointing after Xargon Wars.

Game II — Blagger
Blagger, or the Famous Blagger Goes to Hollywood, is a thief. He has to move around the screen collecting keys, negotiating hazards such as conveyor belts, poisonous plants, collapsing walkways, trains, and other such nasties. When you have all the keys, you must go the safe door. Meanwhile, your energy is gradually ticking away. It's like the Perils of Willy and has many stages. I confess I have only got on to stage 2, which has a giant Commodore logo amongst other things. The other stages promise to be just as good and this is another fun game. The graphics are not stunning and that game is slow (notably it stops when you pick up a key) but it is an important addition to this tape.

Game III — Time Slip
A totally amazing game, the screen is split into three sections and you control one section at a time. The sections are called Zones. Zone 1 is the Planet surface with a starfighter at your disposal. Zone 2 is an underground cavern. Zone 3 is a mini sub. Each zone incorporates different hazards. To succeed you must destroy 12 orbs in each zone. You can interchange between zones after losing a life or if you use the "Fire" function. There is an overall timer which decreases from 24 hours. If you hit fuel pods or oil barrels you gain time, but if you are hit you will lose it. A time-slip occurs after every five losers. Which changes the time on the individual clocks. It is very hard, enjoyable, exciting and addictive and is even better than Xargon Wars. Like Xargon Wars it's the one that makes the tape a good buy.



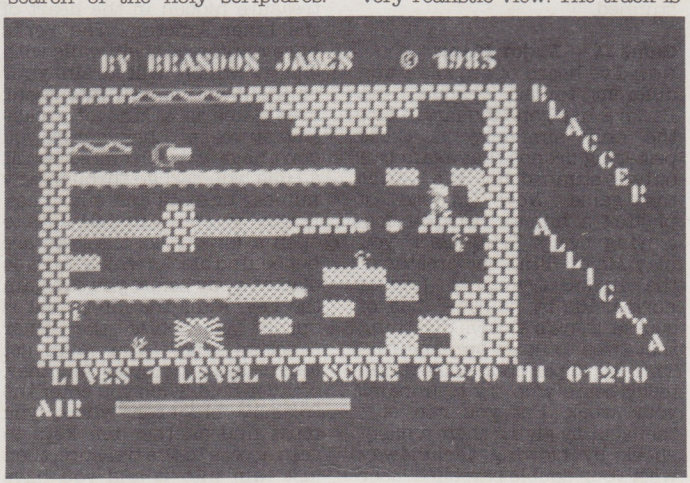
Timeslip

Game IV — Monkey Magic
"Join Monkey on his quest in search of the holy scriptures. This will involve a long and perilous journey on his magic cloud. High in the air you will encounter many evil forces. Use your magic staff to fire at and destroy the evil creatures of the universe."

All this is a defender where your spaceship is a pink cloud. Fairly amusing, it's the sort of game to turn to on a rainy day when you've played some of the others and have run out of ideas. An important fact is that all the games on this tape NOVALOAD, which means you only have to wait two minutes for it to load as compared to ten.

Number 3 — Formula One Simulator — Mastertronic £1.99
Surprising to think that the highest non-compilation tape is a £1.99 game. This is superb value for money. As the name implies it is one of the multitude of racing games. It is to see what has been put into 16K of memory. It has a scenic landscape comprising mountains, bridges, castles and trees, beautifully laid out at the top of the screen that smoothly scrolls as you turn corners, giving a very realistic view. The track is marked out in posts, giving more of a rally car look. You accelerate quickly in low gear up to a speed of 128 mph, then press the fire button and you're in high, joystick forward and you're at 240 mph. The red blob on the horizon comes nearer and increases in size and clarity — a car! Over to the other side of the road, one more successfully negotiated. The wheels screech as you slow down braking round the corners — very realistic. At the bottom of the screen is your score, time left, lap time, gear and high score as well as a wheel which turns as you do. This takes your mind off the fact that you're holding a joystick. The first lap you have 90 seconds in which to complete it and thereafter 60 seconds per lap plus the time you have left. When you do eventually run out of time you get points for every car you've successfully overtaken.

The inlay reads "Based on Formula One, levels of acceleration, braking and road holding, this program has been developed for the ultimate in realism. Get your braking points and line the rough corners in right, hold the car on the tyre squeaking limit, overtaking the other cars if you can and experience all the speed and excitement of motor racing." And for once it's not far wrong. It is the ultimate racing game for the C16 and, although it's not cluttered with dials and billboards, its simplistic beauty is a match for any other version. At £1.99 a definite MUST for all C16 owners. It has only one setback — loading time — but don't all good games?



Blagger

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C16's CLASSICS 4GAMES FOR C16 PLUS4 Gremlin Graphics

C16's CLASSICS PLUS 4

4 HITS FOR THE COMMODORE C16 PLUS 4

4 HITS FOR THE COMMODORE C16 PLUS 4

Dork's Dilemma

Plasma rocket failure. A space shattering collision with a planetoid form not known to any civilised solar system and a dazed, confused Dork awakens to find his disabled spaceship stripped and hidden throughout the underworld kingdom of the evil little Zobwats.

Zobwats? Zobwats! Dark little creatures living in an underground maze.

And they told Dork spacetravel was supposed to be fun.

Xargon Wars

A battle spectacular in the classic mould – defend your mother planet from the alien hordes. Put to test your skills as gunnery commander as the space invaders launch wave after wave of laser bombs. Will your nerve last out and reflexes quicken as each success you attain is met by an even faster attack the following level.

Petals of Doom

Trapped within an eerie space cavern, the only way home is to help the flower plantation reach full growth. Only then will energy curtains blocking your way finally disappear. But, true to all classic space shoot-outs, the plant-hating bugs are out to stamp your flowers to the ground. See the free world again – only if your trigger finger can match the challenge.

Tycoon Tex

Tycoon Tex is a 'rootin', 'tootin' oil tycoon in the true wild west tradition. Guns blazing, eyes gazing, the faster he can make his pipeline patrol the quicker he can add to his bank balance.

Sand, ice or snow can't halt Tex's speedy draw as he fights off the dangers of falling bombs, arrows, surface missiles, and crash explosives. And if he's a second too slow – **!!?? BOOM – one more leak, one barrel less to add to his sticky hoard.

Look out JR you ain't seen nothing yet!

C16's CLASSICS PLUS 4